England's second innings and the game ended in a draw, meaning that we had lost the series 2–1.

England were easily the better team in the series but I must say I was terribly disappointed with the way I performed in the six innings I played in those four Test matches. Anjali had actually come to Nagpur because my frame of mind was not good and when the press saw that she was there, they assumed that I was going to announce my retirement. Something that helped me regain some perspective at the time was a conversation with Ravi Shastri. Ravi and I have always been good friends and in Nagpur we had dinner in my room and he repeatedly told me that I should not start to doubt myself after a few failures. His confidence in me was reassuring and I greatly appreciated the gesture.

Time for change

I took some time off after the England series to clear my mind after all the scrutiny and speculation and to think carefully about my career. I gave retirement some serious thought, but I concluded that I still had the hunger and runs left in me. I might not have made many runs in the England series, but the way I was batting had given me enough confidence to carry on.

One-day cricket was another matter, and India were due to play three ODIs against Pakistan at the end of 2012. I had not played ODI cricket between March and December and I had to ask myself whether I was realistically going to take part in the World Cup in Australia and New Zealand in 2015. If not, what goals would I have left in ODI cricket? I realized I had to accept that I was not going to be around till then. The next question was whether I wanted to play a farewell ODI series against Pakistan before calling it a day. I decided that it was better to take a break and focus my energies on the Australia Test series in February–March 2013.

Having informed the BCCI, the chairman of selectors and Duncan Fletcher of my decision to retire from ODIs, I boarded a flight for Dehradun on my way to Mussoorie, a quiet hill station in the North Indian state of Uttarakhand that I love to visit. A break in Mussoorie is a great way to escape from city life and unwind, and that's what I needed. The news of my retirement had become public while I was in the air between Mumbai and Delhi and as soon as we landed in Delhi I got a